

Fate's Edge

Tactical Combat Module

Optional grid-based skirmish rules

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What this module does

- Adds a *grid* (square or hex, 5 ft cells) to measure distance, line of sight, and reach.
 - Introduces *movement rates*, *terrain costs*, *zones of control (ZoC)*, and *flanking* – all converted directly into the existing *Position* ladder.
 - All actions resolved with standard *Attribute+Skill* pools, **Story Beats (SB)**, **Boons**, and Position/Effect outcomes.
 - **No HP, no new damage tracks.** Harm and Fatigue work exactly as in the core rules.
 - Completely optional – use for one encounter, a whole campaign, or never.
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1 Core Principles

1. **Narrative first.** The grid is a storytelling tool. Every move must be described in fiction.
 2. **No mechanics changes.** Dice pools, **Story Beats (SB)**, **Boons**, Position and Effect work as written.
 3. **Predictable tactics.** Cover, flanking, reach and facing give players concrete ways to gain Position before rolling.
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2 The Grid

2.1 Scale

- **1 square (or hex) = 5 ft.** Square or hex – pick before session.
- Most characters occupy one cell. *Large* creatures (e.g. horse) occupy 2×2.

2.2 Range Bands (grid version)

Close	Adjacent cells (melee)	
Near	Up to 6 cells (≈ 30 ft)	
Far	7–12 cells (≈ 35 –60 ft)	Core range bands still apply; the grid just
Absent	Beyond 12 cells or off-screen	

gives precise counts.

3 Movement

3.1 Movement Rate

- **Move action:** *Body* + 3 cells. (Example: Body 3 → 6 cells)
- **Dash:** Use your action to double movement. After dashing, your *next defence* is at **Desperate**.
- **Difficult terrain:** 2 movement points per cell (mud, rubble, shallow water).
- **Elevation:** Moving *up* costs +1 movement point per level; moving down is free.

4 Zones of Control (ZoC)

- ZoC = all orthogonal (or all six) adjacent cells.
- **Entering** enemy ZoC ends your movement and places you in melee (**Controlled** with that enemy).
- **Leaving** ZoC requires a *Disengage* test: DV 4 (plus any modifiers). Failure leaves you **Desperate** for your next action.
- **Stacked ZoC:** +1 to Disengage DV per extra enemy.
- **Pushing Through ZoC:** To move through an enemy's Zone of Control without ending movement, make a Skill test (Athletics or Acrobatics) vs DV $4 + (N - 1)$, where N is the number of enemies exerting ZoC in the target path. On success, you may continue your movement through the ZoC. On failure, movement ends as normal (entering ZoC places you in melee). *Regardless of outcome, pushing through incurs one cost:*
 - Gain 1 Fatigue,
 - or GM gains 1 Story Beats (SB),
 - or your next action suffers Risky (if currently Controlled) or Desperate (if currently Risky).

(Higher skill ranks improve success chance—veterans thread through chaos where novices falter.)

5 Cover & Position

Partial cover (low wall)	Defender gains Controlled against ranged attacks only.
Full cover (solid wall)	Defender gains Controlled against all attacks; attacker gains Dominant

Cover can be destroyed (GM spends **Story Beats (SB)**).

6 Flanking & Rear Attacks

- **Flanking:** Two allies on opposite sides of a target (orthogonal or hex). Next attacker gains **Dominant** for that attack.
- **Rear attack:** Attacker directly behind target. Gain **Dominant** and upgrade *Standard* to *Great* for that strike.

7 Weapon Tags (Grid interactions)

Tag	Grid Effect
[Reach]	Can attack up to 2 cells away (Near). Enemies without Reach suffer –1 Position when trying to close.
[Fast]	After a successful melee hit, shift 1 cell (no ZoC trigger).
[Set]	Plant weapon as an action. Any enemy that charges into that cell (≥ 4 cells straight) triggers an automatic attack at +1 Effect.
[Brutal]	On a hit, push target 1 cell orthogonally. Target's next defensive Position drops one step.

8 Action Economy (Tactical)

Each turn:

1. **One Action** – attack, cast, use skill, activate talent, etc.
2. **One Move** – up to movement rate (can be taken before, after, or split around the action).

Exceptions: Dashing uses the Action, no separate attack that turn (unless a talent gives a free attack).

9 Position Sources – Quick Lookup

Situation	Position Change
Partial cover (defender)	Controlled (ranged only)
Full cover (defender)	Controlled (all attacks)
Flanking (attacker)	Dominant
Rear attack (attacker)	Dominant + <i>Great</i>
Dashing (defender next)	Desperate
Disengage failure (defender)	Desperate
Spend a Boon before roll	Shift Position up one step

All other Position assignments follow the core rules (terrain, surprise, etc.).

10 Line of Sight & Concealment

- Line of sight blocked by solid obstacles (walls, large creatures, dense forest). GM may call for Notice/Stealth if partially concealed.
- Concealment (fog, smoke, darkness) gives the defender **Controlled** against ranged attacks. Melee unaffected unless attacker must enter the concealed area.

11 Example Turn

1. Harper (Body 4, Melee 5) stands 5 cells from a guard behind a low wall (partial cover).
2. Harper dashes 12 cells, ending adjacent (enters guard's ZoC). Guard now **Controlled**, Harper **Dominant** for his attack.
3. Valeros is already on the opposite side – flanking active.
4. Harper attacks at **Dominant** (flanking bonus). Rolls *Body+Melee* = 9 dice.
5. 6 successes vs DV 3 → clean hit. Harper uses *[Brutal]* to push the guard 1 cell away, out of cover.
6. Guard's next defence is at **Desperate** (push effect).
7. Valeros attacks the now coverless, **Desperate** guard with *[Fast]* dagger, shifts 1 cell after the hit.

Dice, Boons, and Outcome matrix untouched; only Position derived from the grid.

12 GM Guidance

1. Draw the grid early – dry-erase board or VTT.
2. Read Position first: “What is the attacker's Position? What can the defender do to change it?”
3. Spend **Story Beats (SB)** on dramatic consequences (cover collapse, reinforcements, etc.).
4. Use Boons to upgrade Position – a powerful tactical choice.

A Tactical Combat Cheat-Sheet

A.1 Position / Effect Modifiers

Situation	Result
Full cover (defender)	Controlled ; attacker gains Dominant when defending.
Partial cover (defender)	Controlled vs ranged only.
Flanking (attacker)	Dominant .
Rear attack (attacker)	Dominant + <i>Great</i> .
Dashing (defender next)	Desperate .
Disengage failure (defender)	Desperate .
Spend a Boon (before roll)	Shift Position up one step.

A.2 Movement

Rule	Formula / Cost
Base move	Body + 3 cells
Dash (action)	2× move, next defence Desperate
Difficult terrain	2 movement per cell
Elevation up	+1 movement per level (down free)
Run (spend Boon)	2× move, next action Desperate (optional)

A.3 Zones of Control

Action	Effect
Enter enemy ZoC	End movement; in melee (Controlled)
Leave ZoC	Disengage test (DV 4 + modifiers)
Stacked ZoC	+1 DV per extra enemy

A.4 Weapon Tags (Grid)

[Reach]	Attack up to 2 cells; enemies without Reach suffer –1 Position closing.
[Fast]	After hit, shift 1 cell (no ZoC).
[Set]	Plant; charge into cell → automatic attack at +1 Effect.
[Brutal]	Push 1 cell; target's next defence Position drops one step.

A.5 Action Economy

Action	Cost
Attack, cast, skill	1 Action
Move ($\leq$ move rate)	1 Move (can be split)
Dash	1 Action (no other action)
Disengage	1 Action (or free if talent)
Use Boon for Position	1 Boon (before roll)

Tip: Declare your tactical advantage (cover, flanking, high ground) before rolling; the GM sets Position based on the board.

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